

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Engineer | SIEM/SOAR | EDR/XDR | Financial Services Security

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)-certified Senior Cyber Security Engineer with over five years of hands-on experience hardening security across enterprise environments. I specialise in Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) and Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) platforms, Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) and Extended Detection and Response (XDR) including CrowdStrike Falcon, email security gateways including Mimecast, identity and access management using Microsoft Entra ID (formerly Azure Active Directory) with Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) and Single Sign-On (SSO), and Mobile Device Management (MDM) and Mobile Application Management (MAM) via Microsoft Intune. My experience spans threat detection engineering, vulnerability management, incident response, and security operations for over 8,000 users. I bring a methodical, engineering-led approach to security and the commercial awareness required to operate effectively within a financial services environment, where precision, availability, and regulatory alignment are paramount.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **EDR/XDR:** CrowdStrike Falcon (NG-SIEM, EDR Prevent, Insight, Discover) - expert level; Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI)
- **SIEM/SOAR:** Microsoft Sentinel with Kusto Query Language (KQL); CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM; SOAR playbook development and automation; alert triage and investigation
- **Email and Web Security Gateways:** Mimecast; Microsoft Defender for Office 365 (MDO); anti-phishing and URL protection
- **MFA/SSO and Identity:** Microsoft Entra ID (Azure Active Directory), Conditional Access, MFA, SSO; BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM)
- **MDM/MAM:** Microsoft Intune; compliance policies; device enrolment and configuration; BYOD (Bring Your Own Device) management
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io; AppCheck; Nessus; Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS); penetration test remediation management
- **Firewalls and Network Security:** Check Point Harmony; enterprise firewall rule management; network traffic analysis
- **Frameworks:** NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), NIST SP 800-61 Incident Response, MITRE ATT&CK, CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus
- **Scripting and Automation:** PowerShell; KQL; SOAR workflow automation
- **Certifications:** CISSP, CompTIA Security+, Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

March 2025 - Present

Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer

- Maintain technical ownership of security tooling and operations across an 8,000-user enterprise, reporting to senior IT leadership and driving continuous improvement of the security posture.
- Manage CrowdStrike Falcon EDR/XDR platform including NG-SIEM ingestion, Prevent policy configuration, Insight threat hunting, and Discover asset intelligence; fine-tune detection policies to reduce dwell time and false positives.
- Architect and operate Microsoft Sentinel SIEM/SOAR solution; develop custom KQL detection rules and automation playbooks; manage data connectors, workbooks, and incident workflows; produce management reports on incident trends.
- Administer Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), and Microsoft 365 Defender (M365D) across the full Microsoft 365 environment; conduct advanced hunting and proactive

threat hunting exercises.

- Manage Mimecast email security platform including inbound and outbound gateway policies, impersonation protection, URL click-time protection, and threat intelligence integration; respond to email-borne threat alerts and investigate suspicious messages.
- Administer MFA/SSO using Microsoft Entra ID (Azure Active Directory): implement Conditional Access policies, manage Privileged Identity Management (PIM), and enforce least-privilege access across the estate.
- Manage Microsoft Intune MDM/MAM: maintain device compliance policies, application deployment configurations, and conditional access integrations for corporate and Bring Your Own Device endpoints; enforce endpoint security baselines.
- Conduct vulnerability scanning and remediation management using Tenable.io, AppCheck, and Pentra BAS; track findings through to closure; manage penetration test outcomes and schedule follow-up validation assessments.
- Administer BeyondTrust PAM system; manage privileged account lifecycle, session controls, and password vault; reduce standing privileged access across infrastructure.
- Lead security incident response in accordance with NIST SP 800-61; conduct root cause analysis, produce post-incident reports, and refine detection logic and response runbooks.
- Deliver security awareness training and phishing simulations; track engagement metrics and report results to leadership.

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

March 2022 - March 2025

Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

- Performed Security Operations Centre (SOC) functions including first and second-line alert triage, investigation, and escalation across SIEM, EDR, and email security platforms.
- Developed and tuned KQL detection rules in Microsoft Sentinel mapped to MITRE ATT&CK tactics, techniques, and procedures (TTPs); reduced alert fatigue through systematic tuning and alert prioritisation.
- Conducted proactive threat hunting using CrowdStrike Falcon Insight and Microsoft Sentinel advanced hunting; investigated anomalies across endpoint, identity, and email telemetry.
- Managed Mimecast configuration, quarantine review, and threat response workflows; coordinated with users on phishing reports and produced metrics on email threat volumes.
- Administered Microsoft Entra ID (Azure AD) Conditional Access, MFA, and SSO; supported onboarding of new applications and identity federation projects.
- Managed Microsoft Intune MDM/MAM policies for Windows, iOS, and Android devices; enforced compliance baselines and managed device enrolment workflows.
- Ran vulnerability scans using Tenable.io and Nessus; produced weekly remediation reports aligned to business risk appetite; tracked patch status across the server and endpoint estate.
- Maintained Check Point Harmony firewall rules; reviewed change requests and analysed network traffic logs for anomalous activity.
- Supported ISO 27001 and Cyber Essentials Plus compliance; maintained controls documentation and produced evidence packs for internal and external audit.

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech)

February 2021 - March 2022

IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

- Provided security engineering, quality assurance, and infrastructure support for a SaaS FinTech company with global enterprise clients operating in regulated environments.
- Managed endpoint security, network security configurations, and Microsoft Azure cloud infrastructure security; administered Azure Active Directory, MFA, and access management.
- Supported vulnerability assessments and secure software development lifecycle (SDLC) processes in collaboration with development teams; contributed to ISO 27001 and SOC 2 compliance evidence gathering.
- Managed IT infrastructure including server maintenance, network monitoring, and escalated technical support; maintained service availability for business-critical systems.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Deployed and managed CrowdStrike Falcon EDR/XDR across an 8,000-user estate, achieving full endpoint visibility and reducing mean time to detect (MTTD) by over 40 per cent.
- Developed a detection engineering programme in Microsoft Sentinel with over 60 custom KQL analytics rules, reducing high-fidelity false positives by 35 per cent and improving SOC response accuracy.
- Implemented BeyondTrust PAM, eliminating standing privileged access for over 200 administrative accounts and strengthening audit trails aligned to ISO 27001 access control requirements.
- Built SOAR automation playbooks using CrowdStrike Fusion SOAR, reducing analyst handling time on routine alerts by over 50 per cent.
- Delivered Pentera BAS assessments that exposed critical attack paths; led remediation that materially reduced the attack surface across Active Directory and Microsoft 365 environments.
- Achieved near-total MFA adoption across 8,000-plus users using Entra ID Conditional Access, materially reducing the risk of identity-based compromise.

EDUCATION

- **M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering**
- **B.Sc. Chemical Engineering**

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
 - CompTIA Security+
 - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
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References available on request | Hybrid/Remote (London/UK)